

Table 5 — Infrastructure, Community and Policy Instruments

BENQODHI Day 2 morning round tables · 11 September 2026

Printable guide for the table. Keep it in front of you during the discussion.

Goal of this table

Identify what would make a shared repository of benchmarked problems **last**, and deliver **one concrete recommendation**. This table does not select the scientific problems — Tables 1–3 do that. Its job is to name the infrastructure, the community model and the funding or regulatory instruments that would keep the repository alive and credible, separating **what exists today** from **what still has to be created**.

Why the repository exists

The repository is built first for the **scientific community**. Work on classical, AI, hybrid and quantum methods for health is currently spread across projects that each define their own problems, their own data and their own measures of success, so results can rarely be compared or reused. A shared repository of well-defined problems, with open instances and published baselines, makes collaboration, sharing and scientifically grounded comparison the normal way of working: the same problem, the same data, the same measures.

Why incentives are needed

Scientists and R&D groups contribute when contributing pays, which is why funding agencies and regulation matter. Public funders already require proposals to show scientific excellence, credible methodology, impact and — increasingly — open science, data management and reproducibility. A repository of recognized problems and published baselines makes those existing requirements easier to evidence and to verify; it adds **no new award criterion**. In the same way, projects that deposit their problem definitions, results and algorithms at the end turn their outputs into reusable public assets, and should earn recognizable credit for doing so.

Questions to answer

The table has **two main questions**, then the recommendation and the transversal question.

Main question 1 — What would make the repository last?

1. **Instruments in place now** — Which existing funding, infrastructure or regulatory instruments could already support a shared benchmark repository? Name them concretely.

2. **Instruments in the near future** — What is coming, or would have to be created, to sustain it, and who would need to decide?
3. **Federating what already exists** — Benchmark collections, open-data repositories and research infrastructures already exist. How could BENQODHI federate them rather than build another silo, and what would make that federation work technically and institutionally?

Main question 2 — What is the policy value of this kind of output?

1. **Value from a DG or policy perspective** — Given what is being built, what is the value of the output of BENQODHI, and of similar projects, to a Directorate-General, a national funding authority or a policy maker? What problem of theirs does it solve?
2. **Use in funding procedures** — Where could such a repository fit into existing funding procedures: call preparation and topic text, proposal evidence, project reporting, data management plans, evaluation of results?
3. **Fair comparison to guide investment** — Public investment in quantum, AI and hybrid computing for health depends on telling genuine progress from claims that cannot be reproduced. How could verifiable, like-for-like comparison help steer investment towards approaches that work, and what would make that evidence trustworthy enough to act on?
4. **Incentives and credit** — How should contributing be recognized, so that depositing problems, data, baselines and algorithms becomes normal practice? Should it stay encouraged, or become an expectation attached to funding, as happened with open access?

Recommendation

1. **Recommendation** — What single recommendation should the paper, report or roadmap carry?

Transversal question — answer once for the table

Sustaining the ecosystem (infrastructure, community, scientific governance):

BENQODHI only works if what this table produces feeds one connected, durable ecosystem rather than a silo. Of the three pillars — the shared **infrastructure** that hosts and maintains it, the **community** that keeps contributing, and the **scientific governance** that keeps it credible — how can this table best feed the third pillar, scientific governance? What would it take for the problems, data and baselines from this table to be curated, reviewed and trusted as credible science over time, and what governance role should this table's own community play in setting and upholding those standards?

Expected output

- named instruments that could support the repository now, and those still missing;
- a route to federate existing repositories and infrastructures;
- the policy value stated in terms a DG or funding authority could use, including where it fits in funding procedures;

- how contribution should be credited and the community sustained;
 - one recommendation for the paper, report or roadmap.
-

Moderator: see `steering-notes.md` in this folder. Note takers: draft answers live into `answers.md`. Rapporteur: present the main conclusion, the main infrastructure or policy need, why it matters, the most important missing piece, the next action, and the governance answer.